Pattern Headings: Wars

H 1200

Patterns: *United States–History–Civil War, 1861-1865*; *World War, 1939-1945*

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A. Recent revisions

2026-03: Updated template. Clarified text. Separated general and form subdivisions. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

B. Types of headings covered

Headings for individual wars entered directly under their names or as subdivisions under place names. The category includes armed conflicts called by other names, such as coups, revolutions, insurrections, uprisings, invasions, or civil wars.

Examples:

Crimean War, 1853-1856

Turkey--History--Revolution, 1909

Transylvania (Romania)--History--Peasant Uprising, 1437-1438

Spain--History--Coup d'état, 1981

C. Types of headings not covered

The category does not include individual battles of wars, for example, ***El Alamein, Battle of, Egypt, 1942***. For instructions on individual battles, see H 1285. Also not included are riots, demonstrations, protests, strikes, or other unarmed disturbances, terrorist attacks, and headings that use the word "war" metaphorically rather than literally, such as ***War on Terrorism, 2001-2009***.

D. Conflicts

Any subdivision listed here can be used as a free-floating subdivision under any heading belonging to the category if it is appropriate and no conflict exists in the subject authority file. Subject authority records may exist for headings employing variant phrases or subdivisions equivalent to subdivisions on this list.

E. LC practice

If an exceptional variant form is to be retained, make a UF reference from the equivalent free-floating subdivision form following the procedures in H 195 if the reference does not yet exist. Otherwise, submit a proposal to change the variant form along with all bibliographic records requiring correction following the procedures in H 193.

F. Special provisions

F.1. Geographic subdivision

Subdivisions on this list with the notation ***(May Subd Geog)*** should be further subdivided by place only when used after a war established directly under its name, for example, ***World War, 1939-1945***. For a war that is established under its own name and that was fought in a single jurisdiction that is either incorporated or implied in the name, further subdivide by place

in accordance with H 830 only to bring out a place other than the one named or implied in the heading, for example, ***Falkland Islands War--Military intelligence--Great Britain***, or to bring out a locality within that place, for example, ***South African War, 1899-1902--Campaigns--South Africa--Calvinia Region***.

For a war established as a subdivision under the name of a place, generally a civil war or internal armed conflict, for example, ***United States--History--Civil War, 1861-1865***, the subdivisions on this list should not be further subdivided by place.

To bring out place in connection with topical subdivisions on this list which do not further subdivide by place, do not construct a single heading by interposing the place between the heading for the war and the topical subdivision. Instead, assign two headings: one for the war divided by topic and another for the war divided by place, for example, ***World War, 1914-1918--Radar*** and ***World War, 1914-1918--Denmark***.

F.2. The subdivision –Participation, [...]

Use subdivisions of the type *--Participation, [...]*, for example, ***--Participation, Juvenile***, for discussions of the participation of a particular group in the military actions of a war. Discussions of other aspects of a war in relation to a particular group, such as the war's effect on them, should be entered under a heading of the type [*name of war*]–[*name of group*], for example, ***World War, 1939-1945--Children***. The subdivision *--Participation, [nationality]* should be used for works about direct participation of the nationals of the country in the military actions of the war, for example, ***Vietnam War, 1961-1975--Participation, Australian***, as well as for works about foreign economic and technical assistance to the combatants, for example, ***Poland--History--Revolution, 1863-1864--Participation, Swedish***. Do not use *--Participation, [name of group]* for the major combatants in any particular war. Do not use ***--Participation, Foreign*** or *--Participation, [nationality]* under the headings ***World War, 1914-1918*** or ***World War, 1939-1945***. For the participation of a particular country in one of the world wars, use **[*name of war*]--[*country*]**.

F.3. Additional headings for special topics

F.3.a. --Participation, [...]

When assigning *--**Participation, [group of people or nationality]***, assign in addition, either a heading for the group of people involved, subdivided by place if appropriate, or a heading for the country divided by an appropriate subdivision.

F.3.b. Topic and subordinate jurisdictions

For works discussing a subordinate jurisdiction in relation to a war established as a subdivision under a place, assign an additional heading for the subordinate jurisdiction, for example, *__Spain--History--Civil War, 1936-1939__* and *__Aragon (Spain)--History__*. However, for wars established as subdivisions under the heading *__United States--History__*, bring out a locality in connection with the war by establishing the war as an event under the locality, for example, *__Washington (D.C.)--History--Civil War, 1861-1865__*. For *general* works about the war in this locality, assign only the heading for the locality subdivided by the name of the war. For works about a *special* topic of a United States war in connection with a specific locality, however, assign both the general heading for the war with appropriate topical subdivision from the list below, as well as the heading for the locality subdivided by the name of the war and the same topical subdivision.

Example:

```
651 #0 $a United States $x History $y Revolution, 1775-1783 $x Confiscations
       and contributions.
651 #0 $a New York (State) $x History $y Revolution, 1775-1783 $x
       Confiscations and contributions.
```

Do not apply this exceptional practice for any place other than the United States (cf. H 1592, sec. 5.e.).

F.3.c. Other special topics

In cases where a work discusses a specific aspect of a topic covered by a broader subdivision used under wars, assign an additional heading to bring out the specific aspect, if possible. For example, for a work on railroads of the South during the Civil War, assign both the headings *__United States--History--Civil War, 1861-1865--Transportation__* and *__Railroads--Southern States--History--19th century__*.

G. New subdivisions

Establish new subdivisions proposed for this list under ***World War, 1939-1945*** whenever possible. If a subdivision is not appropriate under that heading, establish it under ***United States--History--Civil War, 1861-1865***, if possible. If a subdivision cannot logically be established under either pattern heading, establish it under the specific heading required for the work being cataloged.

H. List of topical subdivisions

Note: For instructions on geographic subdivision, see sec. F.1.

A-B | C-D | E-F | G-H | I-L | M-P | Q-R | S-T | U-Z

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Aerial operations		
$x Aerial operations, American, [British, etc.]		
$x African Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Amphibious operations		
$x Anniversaries, etc.		
$x Antiaircraft artillery operations		
$x Antiquities		
$x Armistices		
$x Art and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Use as a topical subdivision under individual wars for works about art depicting the war, revolution, etc. Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **Spain--History--Civil War, 1936-1939--Art and the war**.
$x Artillery operations		
$x Artillery operations, American, [British, French, etc.]		
$x Asian Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Atrocities	Yes	
$x Autographs		
$x Balloons	Yes	
$x Basques	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Battlefields	Yes	
$x Biography		
$x Biological warfare	Yes	
$x Black people	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Blockades	Yes	
$x Bomb reconnaissance		
$x Camouflage		
$x Campaigns	Yes	
$x Cartography		
$x Casualties	Yes	
$x Causes		
$x Cavalry operations		
$x Censorship	Yes	
$x Centennial celebrations, etc.		
$x Chaplains	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Chemical warfare	Yes	
$x Children	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Civilian relief	Yes	
$x Claims		
$x Collaborationists	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Collectibles	Yes	
$x Commando operations	Yes	
$x Communications		
$x Concentration camps	Yes	
$x Confiscations and contributions	Yes	
$x Conscientious objectors	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Conscript labor	Yes	
$x Cossacks	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Counterfeit money	Yes	
$x Cryptography		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Deaf	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Deception	Yes	
$x Desertions	Yes	
$x Destruction and pillage	Yes	
$x Diplomatic history		Use only under wars established directly under the name of the war. For wars established under names of places, use **[*country*]--Foreign relations--[*period*]**.
$x Draft resisters	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Economic aspects	Yes	
$x Education and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **United States--History--Revolution, 1775-1783--Education and the revolution**.
$x Electronic intelligence	Yes	
$x Engineering and construction		
$x Environmental aspects	Yes	
$x Equipment and supplies		
$x Evacuation of civilians	Yes	
$x Finance	Yes	
$x Fire fighters	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Flags		
$x Food supply	Yes	
$x Forced removal of civilians	Yes	
$x Forced repatriation		
$x Foreign public opinion		Do not use under the headings: **World War, 1914-1918**; **World War, 1939-1945**.
$x Foreign public opinion, Austrian, [British, etc.]		Do not use under the headings: **World War, 1914-1918**; **World War, 1939-1945**.
$x Forest warfare	Yes	
$x Fuel supplies	Yes	

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Gay people	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x German Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Governments in exile		
$x Graffiti	Yes	
$x Health aspects	Yes	
$x Historiography		
$x Hospitals	Yes	
$x Hostages	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x In bookplates		
$x Indians		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Influence		
$x Italian Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Japanese Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Jews	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Journalism, Military	Yes	
$x Journalists	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Jungle warfare	Yes	
$x Language		
$x Law and legislation	Yes	See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Libraries		
$x Literature and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **United States--History--Revolution, 1775-1783--Literature and the revolution**.
$x Logistics	Yes	

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Manpower	Yes	
$x Mass media and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **Spain--History--Civil War, 1936-1939--Mass media and the war**.
$x Medals	Yes	
$x Medical care	Yes	
$x Mexican Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Military currency	Yes	
$x Military intelligence	Yes	
$x Missing in action	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Monuments	Yes	
$x Moral and ethical aspects	Yes	
$x Motion pictures and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **Sino-Vietnamese Conflict, 1979--Motion pictures and the conflict**.
$x Museums	Yes	
$x Music and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Use as a topical subdivision under individual wars for works about songs or music related to the war. Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **Romania--History--Peasants' Uprising, 1907--Music and the uprising.**
$x Name		
$x Naval operations		
$x Naval operations $x Submarine		
$x Naval operations, American, [British, etc.]		
$x Occupied territories		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Participation, African American, [Indian, etc.]		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Buddhist, [Muslim, etc.]		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Communist		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Deaf		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Female		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Foreign		Do not use under the headings: **World War, 1914-1918**; **World War, 1939-1945**. For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Gay		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, German, [Irish, Swiss, etc.]		Do not use under the headings: **World War, 1914-1918**; **World War, 1939-1945**. For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Immigrant		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Indigenous		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Jewish		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Participation, Juvenile		For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Participation, [...]**, see sec. E.2 and sec. E.3.a.
$x Peace		
$x Personal narratives $x History and criticism		
$x Personal narratives, American, [French, etc.] $x History and criticism		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Personal narratives, Jewish $x History and criticism		
$x Photography		
$x Portraits		
$x Postal service		
$x Press coverage	Yes	
$x Prisoners and prisons		
$x Prisoners and prisons, British, [German, etc.]		When this subdivision is qualified by nationality, the qualifier refers to the country controlling the prisons and holding the prisoners of war.
$x Prizes, etc.		
$x Propaganda		
$x Prophecies		
$x Protest movements	Yes	
$x Psychological aspects		
$x Public opinion		
$x Radar		
$x Radio broadcasting and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **Yugoslav War, 1991-1995--Radio broadcasting and the war.**
$x Reconnaissance operations		
$x Reconnaissance operations, American, [German, etc.]		
$x Refugees	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Regimental histories	Yes	For instructions on the use of the subdivision -- **Regimental histories**, see H 1995.
$x Religious aspects		May be subdivided topically by a religion or Christian denomination. Editorially establish each heading of the type **[name of war]--Religious aspects--[name of religion or denomination]** or **[place]--History--[name of war]--Religious aspects--[name of religion or**

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
		denomination]. For instructions on the use of the subdivision, see H 1998.
$x Reparations		Do not subdivide geographically under individual wars.
$x Repatriation of war dead	Yes	
$x Riverine operations	Yes	
$x Riverine operations, American, [British, etc.]	Yes	
$x Science	Yes	
$x Scouts and scouting		
$x Search and rescue operations	Yes	
$x Secret service	Yes	
$x Sermons		
$x Social aspects	Yes	
$x Songs and music		Do not further subdivide **--Songs and music** by **--History and criticism**. Use **--Music and the war, [revolution, etc.]** instead.
$x Sounds		
$x Sources		
$x Tank warfare	Yes	
$x Technology		
$x Television and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **France--History--Revolution, 1789-1799--Television and the revolution**.
$x Territorial questions	Yes	
$x Theater and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **Romania--History--Peasants' Uprising, 1907--Theater and the uprising**.
$x Transportation	Yes	
$x Treaties		
$x Trench warfare	Yes	
$x Trophies		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Tunnel warfare	Yes	
$x Underground literature	Yes	
$x Underground movements	Yes	
$x Underground printing plants	Yes	
$x Unknown military personnel		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Unknown military personnel, American, [British, etc.]		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Urban warfare	Yes	
$x Veterans	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Veterinary service	Yes	
$x War work	Yes	
$x War work $x American Legion		
$x War work $x Boy Scouts		
$x War work $x Catholic Church, [Methodist Church, etc.]		
$x War work $x Churches		
$x War work $x Elks		
$x War work $x Girl Scouts		
$x War work $x Red Cross		
$x War work $x Salvation Army		
$x War work $x Schools		
$x War work $x Young Men's Christian associations		
$x War work $x Young Women's Christian associations		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Women	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Youth	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.

I. List of form subdivisions

LC practice: In early 2025, the use of form subdivisions was phased out. Library of Congress catalogers assign Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT) to bring out the form(s) and/or genre(s) of the resource being cataloged. Therefore, the form subdivisions maintained on this list are not available for use by Library of Congress catalogers. Catalogers at institutions external to LC may use them as dictated by their own institutional policies.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$v Almanacs		
$v Art and the war, [revolution, etc.]		Use as a form subdivision under individual wars for collections of art, including reproductions of art, depicting the war, revolution, etc. Complete the subdivision by repeating the generic term for the type of engagement contained in the heading, for example, **Spain--History--Civil War, 1936-1939--Art and the war**.
$v Autographs		
$v Biography		
$x Casualties $v Statistics		Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under individual wars.
$v Chronology		
$v Gift books		
$v Pamphlets		
$v Personal narratives		The subdivisions **--Personal narratives** and **--Personal narratives** with national or ethnic qualifiers may also be used under headings for battles that are parts of wars. For instructions on the use of **--Personal narratives**, see H 1928.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$v Personal narratives, American, [French, etc.]		The subdivisions **--Personal narratives** and **--Personal narratives** with national or ethnic qualifiers may also be used under headings for battles that are parts of wars. For instructions on the use of **--Personal narratives**, see H 1928.
$v Personal narratives, Confederate		The subdivisions **--Personal narratives** and **--Personal narratives** with national or ethnic qualifiers may also be used under headings for battles that are parts of wars. For instructions on the use of **--Personal narratives**, see H 1928.
$v Personal narratives, Jewish		The subdivisions **--Personal narratives** and **--Personal narratives** with national or ethnic qualifiers may also be used under headings for battles that are parts of wars. For instructions on the use of **--Personal narratives**, see H 1928.
$v Pictorial works		
$v Portraits		
$v Registers		
$v Registers of dead	Yes	
$v Sermons		
$v Songs and music		Do not further subdivide **--Songs and music** by **--History and criticism**. Use **--Music and the war, [revolution, etc.]** instead.
$v Songs and music $v Texts		
$v Sources		
$v Treaties		

Revision history

2026-03: Updated template. Clarified text. Separated general and form subdivisions. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.